

61 Setting the scene

To set the scene in a story, English uses the past continuous to describe the background situation, and descriptive adjectives to say what a place is like.

-  **New language** Past continuous
- Aa Vocabulary** Adjectives to describe places
-  **New skill** Setting the scene for a story

61.1 KEY LANGUAGE PAST CONTINUOUS FOR SCENE-SETTING

The past continuous is formed the same way when setting a scene as for describing past actions in progress.



It was a beautiful day.
The sun **was shining** and the birds **were singing**.
Children **were laughing** and **playing** in the street.



61.2 READ THE STORY AND WRITE ANSWERS TO THE QUESTIONS AS FULL SENTENCES

On a busy morning in Georgetown, Special Agent Zoe Gordon was sitting in her car. The picturesque, peaceful little town was looking charming today, surrounded by the magnificent, open country, where colorful wild flowers were blooming. All was well in this magical, rural town... or was it?

People were shopping and chatting on Main Street. Teenagers were skateboarding along the sidewalk, but Zoe was watching the alleyway between two stores. On the other side of the street, two more agents were in position, waiting for someone to appear.

At 11:00, a suspicious-looking man came out of the alleyway, carrying a large bag. The two agents followed him, and Zoe started her car.

Where was Agent Zoe Gordon sitting?

She was sitting in her car.

① What were people doing on Main Street?

② Where were teenagers skateboarding?

③ What was Zoe watching?

④ What were the two other agents doing?

⑤ What was the suspect carrying?